



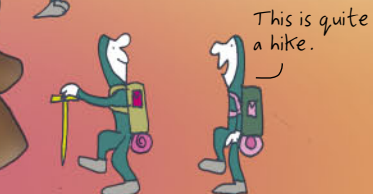
Whale watching

The seas around New Zealand are full of marine mammals, including dolphins, porpoises, and whales, which can often be glimpsed close to the shore.

This is a popular place!

Auckland

Known as the City of Sails, Auckland is famous for its huge number of yachts and other boats, and is home to more than a third of New Zealand's population.



It'll never fly.

The kiwi

The national emblem of New Zealand, the flightless kiwi bird sleeps during the day and is closely related to the ostrich and the emu.



Rugby

The All Blacks—the national rugby team—won the first Rugby World Cup in 1987 and continue to be one of the most successful teams in the world.

Maori

The original Polynesian inhabitants of New Zealand preserve many of their customs, including greeting each other with a hongi (rubbing noses).



Sheep

Wool and lamb are major exports for New Zealand, where there are 10 sheep to every person.

Bungee jumping

Many tourists traveling through New Zealand will stop off for an attempt at bungee jumping, which was invented here.



Geysers

New Zealand lies on a fault between two moving tectonic plates, resulting in its North Island being dotted with grand geysers, hot mud springs, and active volcanoes.

New Zealand

Consisting of two large and many smaller islands, New Zealand lies some 992 miles (1,600km) southeast of Australia. Its South Island is mountainous, while North Island, where most people live, is more volcanic.

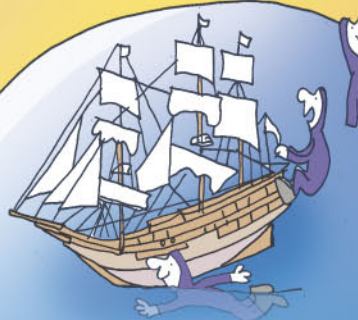
French Polynesia

Nearly three-quarters of French Polynesia's population live on the island of Tahiti, although the territory includes some 130 other islands.



Pitcairn Islands

The remote Pitcairn Islands are home to descendants of mutineers from the HMS Bounty, who landed on the islands in 1790.



Easter Island

Discovered by Europeans on Easter Sunday, Easter Island boasts a series of impressive 400–900-year-old stone statues.



Cook Islands

Fishing for giant clams and pearls is a major source of income for the Cook Islands, as is tourism, while nearby Niue and Tokelau largely rely on the sale of postage stamps and coins.

